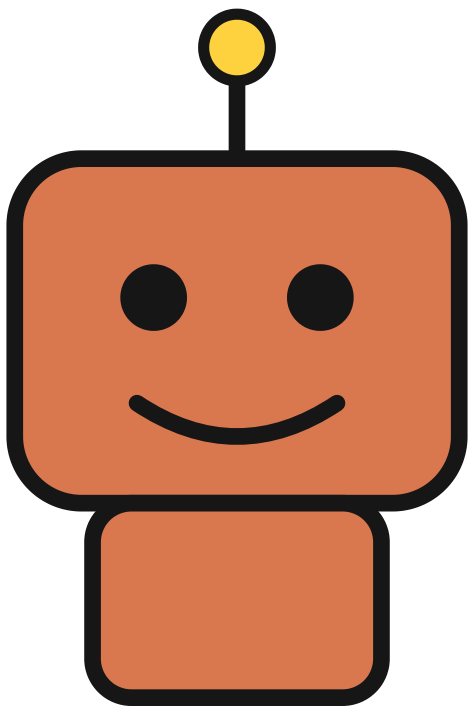
BEFORE / AFTER · THE PUSHBACK SKILL

2 hours of perfect work. On the wrong brief.

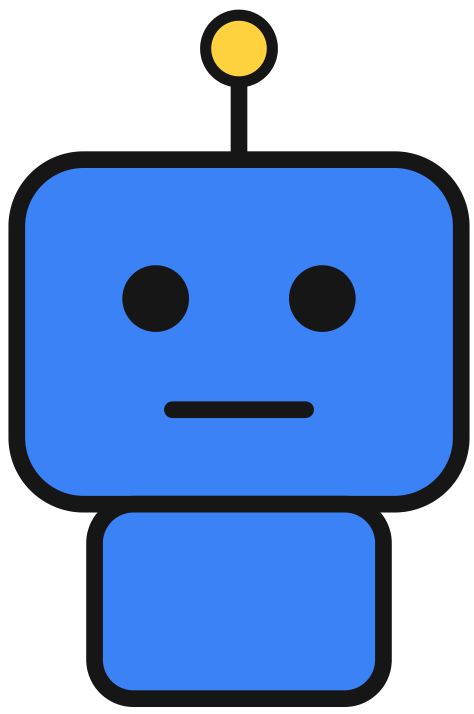
Same request. Two agents. One asks first.

BEFORE



**Guesses.
2 hours. Wrong thing.**

AFTER

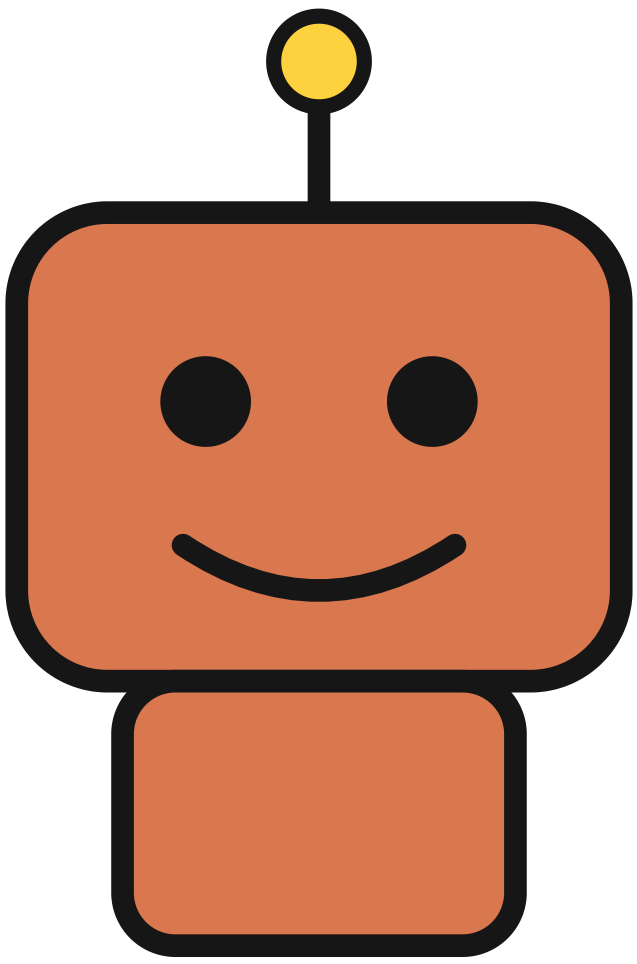


**Asks one question.
10 seconds.**

SWIPE →

BEFORE: NO GATE

You: “Update pricing.”



Picks the likeliest reading.
Works happily for **2 hours.**
Reports success.

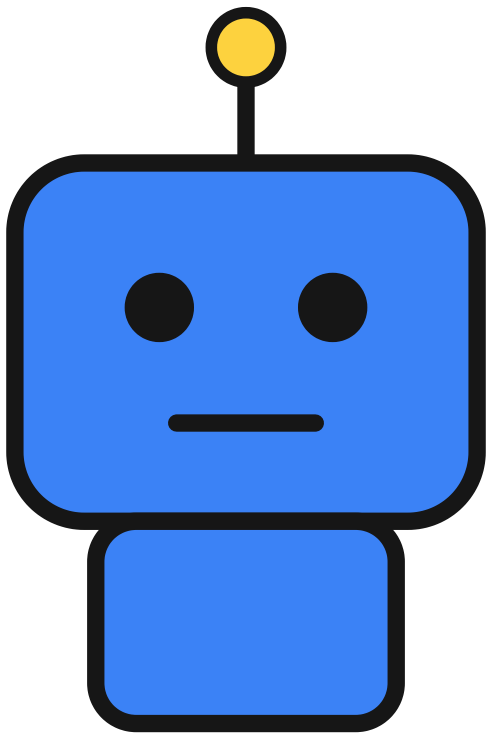
BEFORE: WHAT ACTUALLY CHANGED

✓	✗	✗
Pricing page updated	**Billing** old price	**Docs** a third price

Nothing broke. Every check passed. It built the thing you didn't mean.

AFTER: PUSHBACK

You: “Update pricing.”



“Update pricing” touches 3 places: the site calculator, billing and the docs. Very different rollback costs. Which one, or all three?

AFTER: THE ANSWER

You: “All three.”

10 sec

one message, answered

~~2 hrs~~

the redo you skipped

1. **What I think you meant**
2. **The ambiguity, clash or risk**
3. **One question, or one path with a yes/no**

Say “do it anyway” and it does. It logs one line saying it disagreed.

IT ONLY FIRES WHEN THE BRIEF...

- has 2+ readings
- contradicts a decision
- costs >30 min if wrong
- skips a rule
- is fashion, not a problem

CLAUDE ON THESE TEST CASES



A gate that fires on everything is worthless.